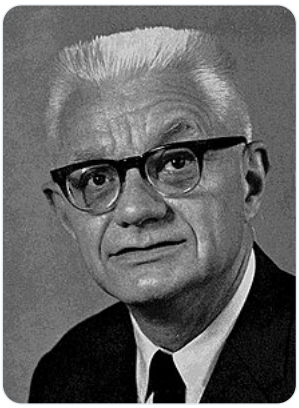
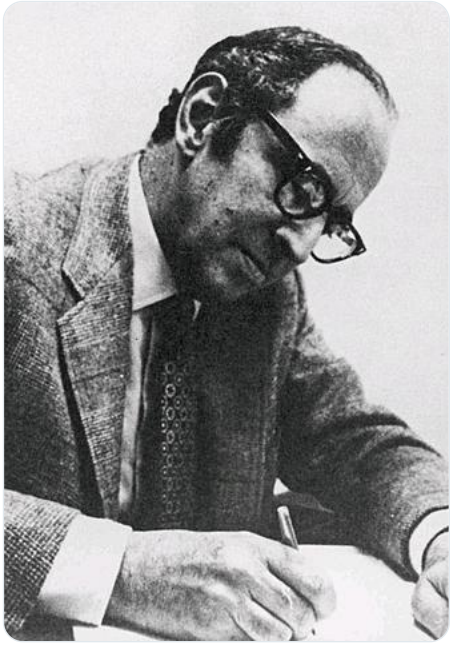
Korobochka (コロボ) @cirnosad

Jul 5, 2023 • 9 tweets • cirnosad/status/1676582503933693952

Normies (including soyentists) think of science as a substitute for religion or mythology. For them, there must be one and only one "scientific explanation" (see Hempel/Whig).
Did know there is nothing in science that is termed a "scientific explanation". Surprised?Read on./🧵

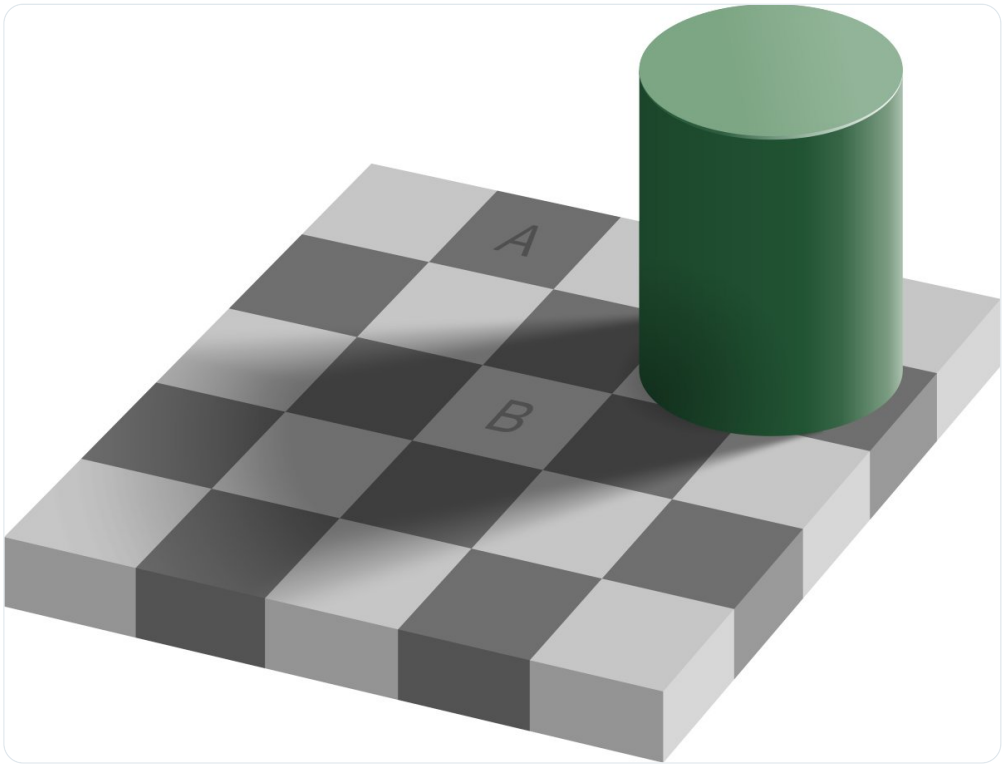




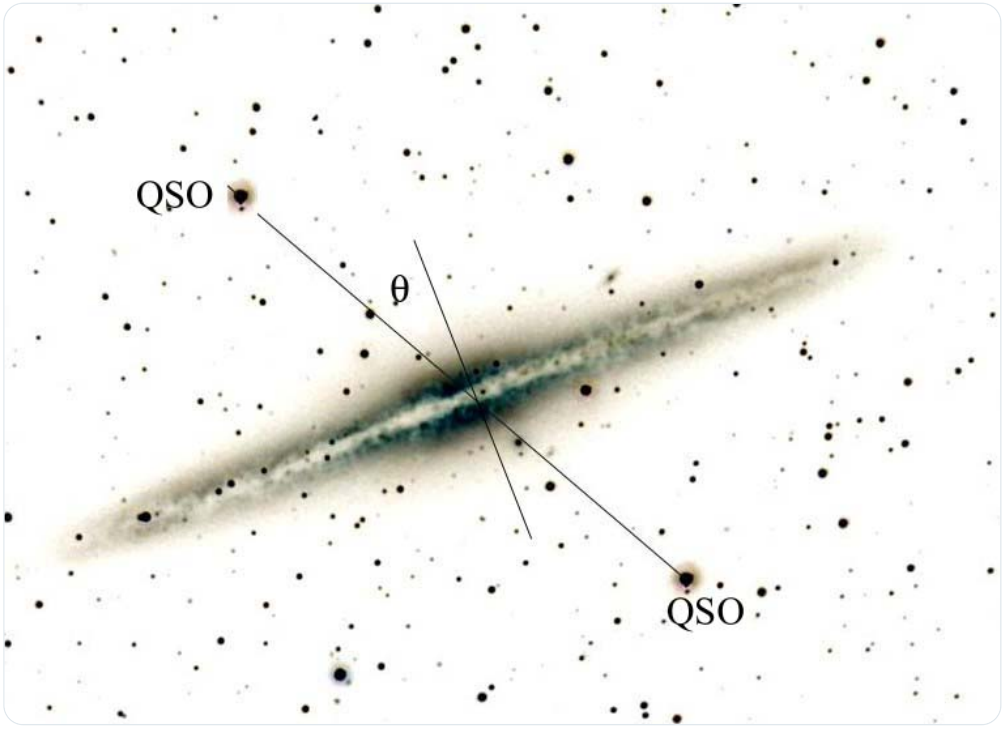
A well studied scientists is able to retain multiple, often contradictory, models in their minds and select the one which is most appropriate for the domain they are dealing with.
Of course, they seek a unified model, but accept that it may not be practical or even possible.

On the other hand, idiot Philosophers such as Hempel, thought they are dealing with truth. They assume some kind of "logical positivism" where only empirically testable observations are worthy of discussion. Anything in between is "superfluous" in this mindset.
As such...

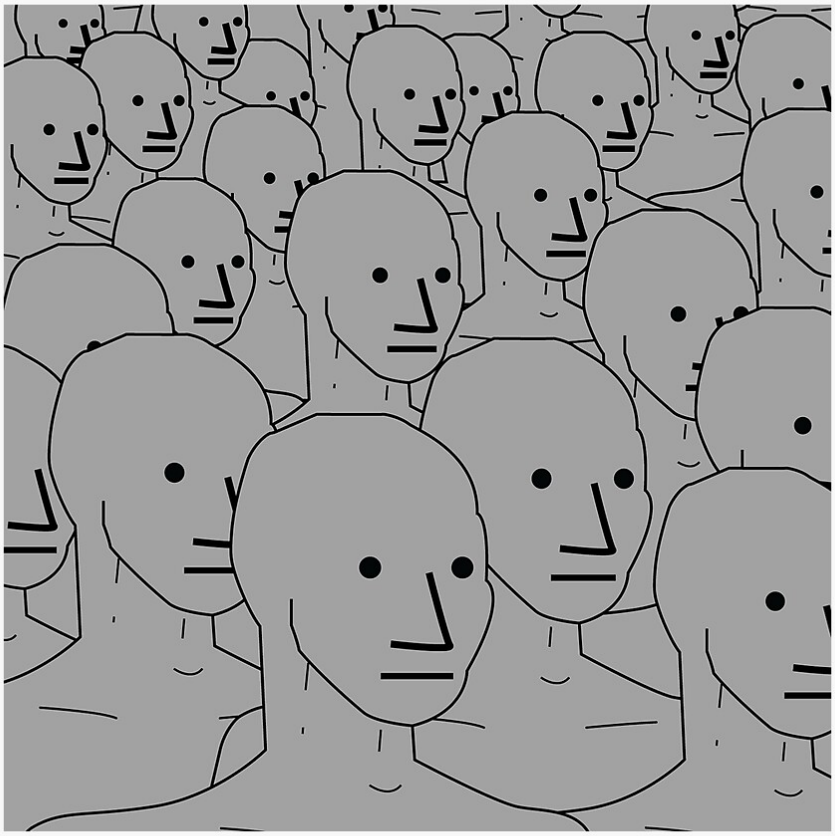
All observations are seen as logical steps towards some kind of unifying "truth". A small bit of paint on a large canvas until we have a full picture of everything.
Such utter nonsense is easily discounted by the knowledge of optical illusions -- sight and vision are different!

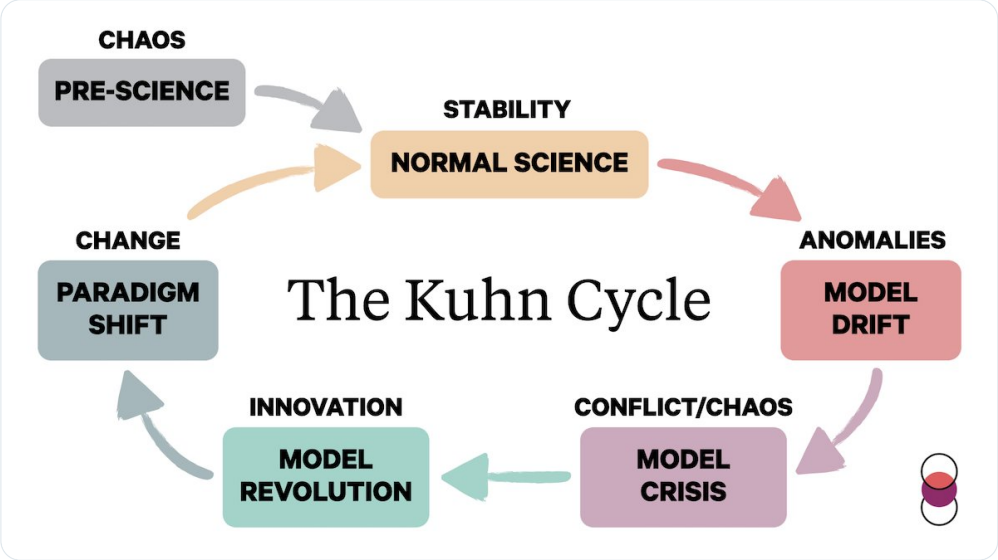


The scientific analogy is straight-forward: your model is directly involved in your measurement. If you adopt one model and one "scientific explanation" you will not converge onto the truth but nonsense! If you don't adopt a model? Your observations won't be tied to any, but all.

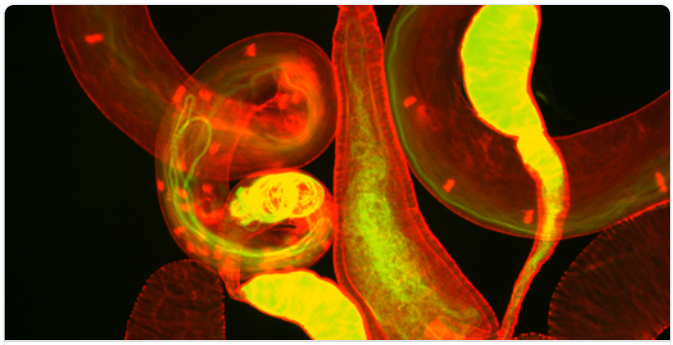


In this mindset, the original creativity involved in science is restored. This is precisely what Thomas Kuhn (a great philosopher/historian) meant by "paradigm shift", it's because this mindset is gone -- and all we have are fools leading fools blindly into the abyss.





Thinking you know the answer -- or demanding an answer to latch on to, instead of accepting that you don't know the answer (embracing stupidity), is the ultimate normie move and is what differentiates a true scientist from a soyentist.



The importance of stupidity in scientific research

I recently saw an old friend for the first time in many years. We had been Ph.D. students at the same time, both studying science, although in different areas. She later dropped out of graduate schoo…

https://journals.biologists.com/jcs/article/121/11/1771/30038/The-importance-of-stupi…

ESSAY | 01 JUNE 2008

The importance of stupidity in scientific research FREE

Martin A. Schwartz

+ Author and article information

J Cell Sci (2008) 121 (11): 1771.
https://doi.org/10.1242/jcs.033340 **Article history**

Split-screen PDF Share Tools

I recently saw an old friend for the first time in many years. We had been Ph.D. students at the same time, both studying science, although in different areas. She later dropped out of graduate school, went to Harvard Law School and is now a senior lawyer for a major environmental organization. At some point, the conversation turned to why she had left graduate school. To my utter astonishment, she said it was because it made her feel stupid. After a couple of years of feeling stupid every day, she was ready to do something else.

I had thought of her as one of the brightest people I knew and her subsequent career supports that view. What she said bothered me. I kept thinking about it; sometime the next day, it hit me. Science makes me feel stupid too. It's just that I've gotten used to it. So used to it, in fact, that I actively seek out new opportunities to feel stupid. I wouldn't know what to do without that feeling. I even think it's supposed to be this way. Let me explain.

who were experts in the various disciplines that I needed. I remember the day when Henry Taube (who won the Nobel Prize two years later) told me he didn't know how to solve the problem I was having in his area. I was a third-year graduate student and I figured that Taube knew about 1000 times more than I did (conservative estimate). If he didn't have the answer, nobody did.

That's when it hit me: nobody did. That's why it was a research problem. And being *my* research problem, it was up to me to solve. Once I faced that fact, I solved the problem in a couple of days. (It wasn't really very hard; I just had to try a few things.) The crucial lesson was that the scope of things I didn't know wasn't merely vast; it was, for all practical purposes, infinite. That realization, instead of being discouraging, was liberating. If our ignorance is infinite, the only possible course of action is to muddle through as best we can.

So next time you point out a huge gaping hole in a widely accepted theory and someone pops up demanding an alternate model to latch onto, you know exactly why. They need a "scientific explanation" in the Hempelian (heh) sense.

If that's you: open your eyes to your own blindness!

Here's my own story and how I discovered how rotten our system of knowledge is early on, later I discovered it may not be so organic in how it was led, but to demonstrate that I must go through much more material in order to convince you.

Until next time.

Korobochka (コロボ) 🇦🇺✝️🇷🇺
@cirnosad · Follow

An "elite" parable:

During my early university days, I fell very ill. I could not play sports or really keep up with many of my friends. My favorite place in the world quickly became the library and I went deeper into its depth and read engineering, math and science books. 🧵

11:00 AM · Oct 1, 2022

126 Reply Copy link

Read 10 replies

• • •